

Day 1: April 1 Cusco

Arrival to Cusco and transfer to hotel in Cusco.

Day at leisure to rest

Hotel Anden Inca

Day 2: April 2 Cusco, city tour.



9:00 a.m. Visit the city known as the “Archaeological Capital of America.” The ancient capital of the Incas is a place full of archaeological sites, museums, and temples. We will begin our city tour at 9:00 a.m., picking you up from your hotel and heading out to visit the different complexes.

Cusco Cathedral, or Basilica of the Assumption, is one of the city's most popular architectural monuments. It is also the first site you will visit. It is located opposite the Plaza de Armas. Its construction took almost 100 years to complete in 1654. It was originally an Inca temple dedicated to the god Wiracocha. During the Spanish conquest, the temple was looted and demolished to build this historic Catholic monument. In 1983, it was declared a World Heritage Site by UNESCO.

Coricancha and Convent of Santo Domingo – Coricancha is one of the most important religious centers of the Inca Empire. Its stone constructions are even more perfect than Machu Picchu. It was covered in gold and plants until the Spanish conquest, when the Convent of Santo Domingo was built there. It is located two blocks from the Plaza de Armas. It houses paintings by artists from the so-called ‘Cusco School’. Both Coricancha and the Convent of Santo Domingo coexist harmoniously as symbols of cultural syncretism.

Sacsayhuaman Complex – Sacsayhuaman is one of the most enigmatic sites of the Incas. There, tourists can see stones up to nine meters high and weighing more than 120 tons. All of them fit together with incredible precision. The Spanish believed that the site was the work of the devil. Fierce battles were fought there between the Incas and the Europeans. Today, it is one of the most symbolic attractions in Cusco and Peru.

Every June 24, the famous “Fiesta del Sol” (Festival of the Sun), also known as Inti Raymi, is celebrated there.

Qenqo Archaeological Site is located approximately 1 kilometer from Sacsayhuaman. It was an Inca ceremonial center whose buildings were dedicated to Mother Earth. There is a notable space called the amphitheater where the Incas placed their dead in trapezoidal niches. Its main attraction is its underground labyrinths. In fact, the word “Qenqo” in Quechua (the language of the Incas) means “labyrinth.”

Archaeological site of **Tambomachay** is one of the most beautiful archaeological sites. It is located approximately 400 meters from Puca Pucara. Its Inca constructions worship water with such perfection that even today, after several centuries, its canals still flow with water. The site also consists of a set of finely carved rocks as well as waterfalls, canals, and aqueducts fed by springs. The scenic beauty of the site harmonizes with the buildings and the sound of the water.

Cusco Textile Center offer a demonstration of the process of spinning and dyeing garments made from alpaca and other materials used in Cusco for many years. In addition, each visitor will be able to learn about the different types of materials such as alpaca, baby alpaca, vicuña, and more. At the end, tourists can purchase garments and other handicrafts made by Cusco artisans.

Return to the hotel at approximately 7 pm.

Meals: Breakfast

Hotel Anden Inca ***

Day 3: April 3 Classic inca trail 04 days/03 nights.

Cusco – Km. 82 (2,800 m) – Huayllabamba (3,000 m)



Early in the morning, we will pick you up at your hotel and then travel by private bus to Piscacucho, located at kilometer 82 (2,800 m / 9,186 ft). On the way, we will pass through the Sacred Valley of the Incas, through the towns of Urubamba and Ollantaytambo, where we will make a short stop so you can visit the local market and buy some provisions for the hike. We will then continue our journey to Piscacucho. Upon arrival at Piscacucho Km. 82, we will pass through the checkpoint to begin the hike along the banks of the Urubamba River.

In this first section of the Inca Trail, we will visit the small community of Miskay (2,800 m / 9,186 ft). and later we will begin to ascend to a small plateau, where we can enjoy an extraordinary Andean landscape and an Inca construction known as Patallacta, located at 2,750 m / 9,022 ft. Here we can see some agricultural terraces that were used to feed travelers from different places who took this route to reach Machu Picchu.

We will then continue walking through an area full of vegetation where it is very likely to see the giant hummingbird. After walking for about 2 hours, we will arrive at our first camp located in the Huayllabamba area at 3,000 m / 9,842 ft. Huayllabamba is a small town surrounded by cornfields, potato crops, and other produce. Here we will set up our first camp.

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and dinner

Camp

Day 4: April 4 Huayllabamba – Pacaymayo



Today we will face a great challenge: climbing the Warmihuañusca pass. We will start with a hearty breakfast, then begin our hike towards the Ayapata Valley, which will take 1 hour to reach. This area is known for its high Andean valley microclimate. Then we will pass through a narrow trail full of vegetation, crossing a small bridge that will take us through a cloud forest of unparalleled beauty until we reach the highest point of Warmihuañusca, a name in Quechua that means “When the woman dies.” This point has an altitude of 4,200 m / 13,779 ft. Throughout the climb, you will be able to appreciate how the vegetation changes. However, this place is one of the most beautiful, because once we have conquered its summit, we will be rewarded with a beautiful view of the snow-capped mountains and Andean landscapes.

We will then descend through a winding valley until we reach a spot where we will stop for lunch. During this journey, it is possible to observe various types of birds. We will continue along the route until we reach the Pacaymayu River Valley (3,600 m / 11,811 ft), where we will set up our second camp.

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and dinner

Camp

Day 5: April 5 Pacaymayo – Wiñayhuayna



For many visitors, this is one of the longest days, but at the same time one of the most beautiful, due to the presence of Inca constructions along the trail. After a nutritious breakfast, we will begin our hike by ascending a steep path. We will pass through a second pass where we will find the impressive archaeological remains of Runkuracay (3,800 m / 12,467 ft), which takes its name from its unique semicircular shape. This semicircular shape provides protection from the strong winds in the area. We will then ascend to the Yanacocha lagoon (Black Lake) and continue until we reach Sayaqmarca (3,600 m / 11,811 ft), “The Dominant Village,” where we will see interesting Inca ruins. and enjoy a panoramic view of the Acobamba Valley. The only way to access these structures is via a steep stone staircase. During the tour, we will pass through Conchamarca, a small, recently discovered archaeological site.

Then, we continue uphill and arrive at the first tunnel along the way, then continue climbing until we reach the third and final pass, where we will see the village of Phuyupatamarca (3,665 m / 12,024 ft), “Village above the clouds,” which is undoubtedly one of the most original citadels along the Inca Trail. It is located on the edge of a ravine. Here we will find many agricultural terraces and ceremonial fountains. After visiting this site, we will descend about 2,000 stone steps to reach the citadel of Wiñaywayna (2,700 m / 8,858 ft), which means “Forever Young,” the name deriving from the typical orchids that can be found throughout the year with their red, yellow, and violet flowers. This is possibly the most attractive of all the palaces along the Inca Trail and the last urban center before reaching Machu Picchu. Built on the slopes of the mountains, it is divided into four main parts: the lower housing area, with more than 20 buildings; the area for ritual celebrations; the area of agricultural terraces; and the tower area. After exploring every corner of Wiñaywayna, we will head to our last camp, which is located a few meters from the site. This will be the night we say goodbye to our porters and tour staff, so there will be a small party in the evening to thank everyone for sharing this beautiful experience with the group.

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and dinner

Camp

Day 6: April 6 Wiñayhuayna – Machu Picchu



On this last day, we will get up very early to have breakfast and then continue our hike. After three hours of walking, we will arrive at the Intipunku or Sun Gate area (2,490 m / 8,169 ft). This is a small complex of buildings that appear to have been used as a control point. It is an excellent opportunity to take panoramic photos of the citadel of Machu Picchu. If travelers have started the hike very early, they will arrive just in time for sunrise. This is perhaps the best place and time to contemplate the majestic splendor of Machu Picchu, the Lost City of the Incas.

For a long time, Machu Picchu was thought to be part of a legend, until 1911 when American explorer Hiram Bingham discovered it. Machu Picchu rises to a height of 2,430 m / 7,972 ft in the middle of a tropical forest, and has an extraordinary location. It was undoubtedly one of the most marvelous urban creations during the Inca heyday. Its enormous walls, terraces, and ramps appear to have been naturally cut into the rocky cliffs.

We will then descend to explore the Inca Citadel of Machu Picchu, where we will have a guided tour with our guide lasting approximately 2 hours, followed by free time for you to enjoy this wonder of the world independently. You can visit Huayna Picchu (not included in the tour).

Afterwards, we will descend by bus to Aguas Calientes (2,160 m / 7,087 ft), where you can visit the town's hot springs (the 10 Soles entrance fee is not included in the tour).
Return to Cusco

Meals: Breakfast

Hotel Anden Inca ***

Day 7: April 7 Cusco – Lima

Transfer to Cusco airport

Cost per person \$980.00 american dollars

Included

- 3 nights in a 3-star hotel with breakfast included
- City tour with entrance fees
- Transfers
- Meeting with the guide prior to the hike for detailed information about the hike and to receive the corresponding map.
- Professional guide
- Cook
- Porter to carry your belongings (6 kilos per person)
- Porters to carry camping equipment (tents, thin mattresses) and food.
- Meals (3 breakfasts / 3 lunches / 3 dinners).
- Sleeping bag
- Free vegetarian option; please inform us in advance.
- First aid kit, oxygen tank.
- Camping equipment (tents + mattresses).
- Cooking equipment (kitchen tent, dining tent, utensils).
- Transportation from Cusco Hotel to Km 82.
- Entrance ticket to the Inca Trail and Machu Picchu.
- Guided tour of Machu Picchu for 2 hours.
- Bus from Machu Picchu to Aguas Calientes.
- Train from Aguas Calientes to Ollantaytambo (Expedition service)
- Transportation from Ollantaytambo to Cusco.

Important

- When making your reservation, all information must match that on your passport or identity document.
- It is mandatory to carry the original passport or identity document with which you made the reservation throughout the entire Inca Trail tour.
- Tips for guides, cooks, and porters are not included in the tour price (it is optional if you wish to give a tip; it is not mandatory)

What to bring

- Personal hygiene items.
- Waterproof hiking boots or shoes.
- Hiking stick rental \$10.00
- Camera.
- Hat or cap.
- Long-sleeved shirts
- Rain gear during the rainy season (waterproof pants or jacket)
- Headlamp and batteries.
- Long pants.
- Insect repellent.
- Sunscreen.
- Sweaters and a jacket.
- Medium-sized backpack (approx. 40 liters) for hiking.
- Warm clothing for the evenings.
- Sleeping bag.
- Walking sticks.

Email: info@machupicchuet.com

Address: Av Velasco Astete F-2 Urb Santa Lucia Wanchaq Cusco Peru